MIL-H-27601A(USAF)
7 January 1966

SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-27601(USAF)
23 January 1964

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HYDRAULIC FLUID, PETROLEUM BASE, HIGH TEMPERATURE, FLIGHT VEHICLE

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the requirements for a petroleum-base hydraulic fluid.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

BB-N-411	Nitrogen, Technical
QQ-C-576	Copper Plates, Rolled Bars, Sheets, and Strips
QQ-S-763	Steel Bars, Shapes, and Forgings, Corrosion-Resisting
TT-T-656	Tricresyl Phosphate

Military

MIL-S-8840	Steel Sheet and Strip, Corrosion-Resistant, Precipitation Hardening (AM 350), (Aircraft Applications)
MIL-S-13282	Silver
MIL-R-25897	Rubber, High-Temperature, Fluid-Resistant

STANDARDS

Federal

Fed Test Method Std No. 791	Lubricants, Liquid Fuels, and Related Products; Methods of Testing

FSC 9150

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STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-290	Packaging, Packing and Marking of Petroleum and Related Products

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials Publication

ASTM Standards on Petroleum Products and Lubricants

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia 3, Pennsylvania.)

Aeronautical Material Specification

AMS 4917	Titanium Alloy, Plate, Sheet, and Strip, 13.5V 11Cr 3Al, Solution Treated

(Copies of AMS publications may be obtained from the Society of Automotive Engineers, Inc., 485 Lexington Avenue, New York, New York 10017.)

Code of Federal Regulation

Title 49, Transportation, Part 78, I.C.C. Shipping Container Specification 17E

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20360.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Qualification. The hydraulic fluid furnished under this specification shall be a product which has been tested and

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passed the qualification tests specified herein, and has been listed on or approved for listing on the applicable qualified products list.

3.1.1 Requalification. Requalification shall be required in the event any change is made in the composition, source of ingredient, or source of manufacture of the hydraulic fluid.

3.2 Materials. The materials used in compounding the hydraulic fluid shall consist of and be limited to a paraffinic base stock of natural hydrocarbon (see 3.2.1), and shall contain additives as specified in 3.2.2.

3.2.1 Properties of the hydrocarbon base stock. The properties of the base stock prior to blending of the additives (see 3.2.2) shall conform to the requirements of table I.

Table I. Properties of the hydrocarbon base stock

Property	Value
Pour point, max	-65° F (-53.8° C)
Flash point, min	360° F (182.2° C)
Acid or base number, max	0.10
Trace sediment, volume % (max)	0.025
Color (Saybolt) min	+20
Volatility, 5% boiling point, min	415° F
Specific gravity at 60° F/60° F (15.6° C/15.6° C)	Report

3.2.2 Additives. Additives other than specified herein shall not be used unless specifically approved by the procuring activity.

3.2.2.1 Oxidation inhibitor. The oxidation inhibitor shall be a hindered bis-phenol. (An example of a known suitable additive is 4,4' methylenebis (2,6-di-tertiary butyl phenol.) A quantity of 0.45 to 1.0 percent by weight shall be used.

3.2.2.2 Antiwear agent. The antiwear agent shall be tricresyl phosphate conforming to TT-T-656, in a quantity of 0.70 to 1.05 percent by weight of the hydraulic fluid.

3.3 Properties of the hydraulic fluid. The properties of the hydraulic fluid shall conform to the requirements of table II and 3.3.1 through 3.3.8 (see 4.5).

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Table II. Properties of the hydraulic fluid

Property	Value
Viscosity at -65° F (-53.8° C) centistokes	Report
Viscosity at -40° F (-40° C) centistokes, max	4000
Viscosity at 0° F (-17.8° C) centistokes, max	385
Viscosity at 210° F (98.9° C) centistokes, min	3.20
Viscosity at 550° F (288° C) centistokes, min	Report
Viscosity index, min	89
Pour point, max	-65° F (-53.8° C)
Flash point, min	360° F (182.2° C)
Acid or base number, max	0.20
Trace sediment, volume % (max)	0.025
Dielectric strength (volts/mil) 68° F (20° C), min	300
Specific heat (BTU/lb °F) at 200° F, min	0.484
Thermal conductivity (BTU/(sq ft)(hr)(°F)/ft) at 400° F, min	0.063
Thermal expansion per °F at 400° F, max	0.00060
Bulk modulus (isothermal secant, 0 to 10,000 psi) at 100° F (37.8° C) psi, min	200,000

3.3.1 Specific gravity. The specific gravity of the hydraulic fluid shall be determined but not limited (see 4.5). Samples of hydraulic fluid submitted for acceptance tests shall not vary more than ±0.008 at 60° F/60° F (15.6° C/15.6° C) from the specific gravity of the sample approved by qualification testing.

3.3.2 Corrosiveness and oxidation stability. When tested as specified in 4.5.1, the change in weight of the silver, steel, and titanium specimens shall be not more than 0.2 milligram (mg) per square centimeter of surface, and the weight change in the copper shall be not more than 0.6 mg per square centimeter of surface.

3.3.2.1 Resistance to oxidation. The hydraulic fluid viscosity shall be within -5 to +20 percent of the original viscosity in centistokes at 100° F (37.8° C) maximum after the corrosiveness and oxidation stability test (see 4.5.1). After oxidation, the total acid or base number shall be not more than 2.0. Insoluble materials shall be limited to 0.1 g/100 ml.

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3.3.3 Thermal stability. When tested as specified in 4.5.2, the change in original viscosity of the hydraulic fluid at 100° F (37.8° C) shall be not more than 25 percent, change in weight of the metal catalysts shall be not more than 0.1 mg per square centimeter of surface, and the total acid or base number shall be not more than 0.40.

3.3.4 Swelling of synthetic rubber. When tested in accordance with 4.5.3, the average volume increase of the synthetic rubber shall be not more than 10 percent. Shrinkage of the elastomer shall not be acceptable.

3.3.5 Lubricity. When tested in accordance with Fed Test Method Std No. 791, method 6514 (see 4.5) wear values for the hydraulic fluid shall be as specified in table III.

Table III. Wear values

Load (kg)	Scar diameter mm (max)
1	0.21
10	0.30
40	0.65

3.3.6 Solid particle contamination. When tested in accordance with Fed Test Method Std No. 791, method 3009 (see 4.5), in a clean, dust-free atmosphere, the number of solid contaminant particles per 100 ml of fluid shall be not more than the number specified in table IV. The filtering time for each determination shall be 15 minutes maximum.

Table IV. Solid contaminant particles

Particle size range (largest dimension) microns	Allowable number each determination (max)
5 to 15	2500
16 to 25	1000
26 to 50	250
51 to 100	25
Over 100	5

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3.3.7 Compatibility. The hydraulic fluid shall be compatible in all concentrations with each of the fluids qualified under this specification (QPL 27601) when tested as specified in 4.5.4.

3.3.8 Foaming characteristics. The foaming characteristics of the hydraulic fluid shall be as shown in table V when tested as specified in 4.5.

Table V. Foaming characteristics of hydraulic fluid

Test	Foaming tendency	Foam stability
	Foam volume, ml, at end of 5-minute blowing period (max)	Foam volume, ml, at end of 3-minute settling period
At 75° F	75 ml	Complete collapse
At 200° F	75 ml	Complete collapse
At 75° F after test at 200° F	75 ml	Complete collapse

3.4 Water content. The total water content of the fluid shall not exceed 0.01 percent.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of tests. The inspection and testing of the hydraulic fluid shall be classified as qualification tests and quality conformance tests.

4.3 Qualification testing

4.3.1 Qualification test samples. Qualification test samples shall consist of 2 gallons of the hydraulic fluid, 1 gallon of the hydrocarbon base stock before addition of the additives, 8 ounces of tricresyl phosphate, and 1 ounce of the oxidation

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inhibitor. In the event that additives are supplied as concentrated solutions, an equivalent quantity of the solution shall be furnished. Samples shall be prominently identified by securely attached, durable tags marked with the manufacturer's own number and any additional information required by the letter of authorization (see 6.3).

4.3.1.1 Test report. Qualification samples shall be accompanied by a certified test report containing complete information as to the source and type of base stock and additive materials used, the formulation and composition of the hydraulic fluid, and laboratory data showing quantitative results of all tests required by this specification.

4.3.1.1.1 Formulation sheets. An example of a satisfactory form for the formulation sheet, indicating the percentage and nature of each ingredient, is as follows:

Hydrocarbon base stock (composition)	Percent
Tricresyl phosphate additive (mfr's name and no.)	Percent
Oxidation inhibitor (mfr's name and no.)	Percent

4.3.2 Qualification required. Separate qualification tests shall be conducted for each base stock.

4.3.3 Qualification tests. Qualification tests shall consist of tests for all requirements specified in section 3.

4.4 Quality conformance inspections

4.4.1 Inspection requirements. Inspection shall be in accordance with method 9601 of Fed Test Method Std No. 791.

4.4.2 Sampling for lot acceptance

4.4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all hydraulic fluid manufactured from one base stock as one batch and offered for delivery at one time. A batch is defined as the end product of all raw materials mixed or blended in a single operation.

4.4.2.2 Samples for quality conformance tests. Samples for quality conformance tests (see 4.4.4) shall be selected from each lot in accordance with method 8001 of Fed Test Method Std No. 791 (equivalent to ASTM Standard D270).

4.4.2.3 Samples for inspection of filled containers. A random sample of filled containers shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level II, and acceptance quality level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective to verify compliance

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with this specification in regard to fill, closure, marking and other requirements not involving tests.

4.4.2.4 Samples for determination of solid particle contamination. Samples of filled and sealed containers shall be taken at such periodic intervals as to be representative of each day's operation. The number of samples taken each day shall be the cube root (to the nearest whole number) of the total number of containers filled that day. The sample size and the number of determinations (tests) per sample for container indicated shall be:

One-quart can	100 ml	1 determination (test)
One-gallon can	200 ml	2 determinations (tests)
Five-gallon pail	300 ml	3 determinations (tests)
Fifty-five gallon drum	600 ml	6 determinations (tests)

Should the particle count on any individual sample be considered excessive, two additional determinations on another sample from the same container may be used. The container shall be thoroughly shaken immediately prior to withdrawing each 100-ml portion for such additional determinations. The arithmetric average of the two closer particle counts shall be considered the particle count for the sample.

4.4.3 Inspection of filled containers and preparation for delivery requirements. Each container selected in accordance with 4.4.2.3 shall be visually examined for defects of construction of the container and the closure, for evidence of leakage, for markings, and all other preparation for delivery requirements to determine compliance with section 5. Each sample container shall also be weighed to determine the amount of contents. Any container in the sample having one or more defects, or under the required fill, shall be rejected, and if the number of defective containers in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for the specified sampling plan of MIL-STD-105, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.4 Quality conformance tests. Quality conformance tests for acceptance of individual lots shall consist of tests for the following requirements specified in section 3:

a. Viscosity at -40° F (-40° C).

b. Viscosity at 210° F (98.9° C).

c. Pour point.

d. Flash point.

e. Acid or base number.

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f. Trace sediment.

g. Dielectric strength.

h. Specific gravity.

i. Solid particle contamination.

j. Water.

4.5 Test methods. Tests shall be conducted in accordance with Fed Test Method Std No. 791, or ASTM standards, using applicable method as listed in table VI, and 4.5.1 through 4.5.7.

Table VI. Test methods

Test	Test Method	
	Fed Std No. 791	ASTM Standard
Pour point	-	D97
Flash point	-	D92
Acid and base numbers	5105	-
Trace sediment	3004	-
Color (base stock)	-	D156
Volatility (base stock)	-	1/ D1160
Specific gravity	-	D287
Viscosity	-	D445
Viscosity index	-	D567
Dielectric strength	-	D877
Thermal expansion	-	D1250
Solid particle contamination	3009	-
Foaming	-	D892
Water	-	D1744
Lubricity	2/ 6514	-

1/ The test shall be conducted at 10 mm of mercury absolute pressure.

2/ The test shall be conducted at 600 rpm for 1 hour at each load specified in table III.

4.5.1 Corrosiveness and oxidation stability. The hydraulic fluid shall be tested in accordance with method 5308 of Fed Test Method Std No. 791, except as specified herein. The hydraulic fluid specimen shall be 100 ml. The temperature of the bath shall be 347° F ± 5° F (175° C ± 3° C), and the test metals

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shall be copper conforming to QQ-C-576, type 350 stainless steel conforming to MIL-S-8840, B120VCA titanium conforming to AMS 4917, type 440 stainless steel conforming to QQ-S-763, and silver conforming to MIL-S-13282, grade A. The configuration of the metal test specimen shall be as shown on figure 1. The test shall be run for 48 hours at 5 ± 0.5 liters per hour flow rate of air. Subsequently, the fluid used in the foregoing test shall be filtered through a 10-micron membrane filter and the fluid volume determined. The filter shall then be washed with petroleum ether and weighed. The sludge calculated per 100 ml of filtered fluid, shall not exceed 0.1 g/100 ml of filtered fluid.

4.5.2 Thermal stability. The thermal stability test shall be conducted in a 46-ml capacity stainless steel pressure cylinder conforming to figure 2. Catalysts of each M-10 tool steel, 52100 steel, and naval bronze shall be in the form of 0.5-inch ball bearings. The cylinder shall be charged with a 20-ml sample of the candidate hydraulic fluid, and the catalysts placed in the cylinder. The system shall be purged with nitrogen, sealed at atmospheric pressure, and test begun. The temperature shall be raised to 700° ± 10° F (371° ± 6° C) and temperature maintained for 6 hours. The nitrogen pressure at 700° F (371° C) is approximately 20 psig. Change in viscosity, catalyst weight loss and acid or base number shall be reported.

4.5.3 Swelling of synthetic rubber. The swelling effect of the hydraulic fluid on sheet synthetic rubber conforming to MIL-R-25897 shall be determined in accordance with method 3603 of Fed Test Method Std No. 791, except as specified herein. The test shall be performed at a temperature of 400° ± 2° F (204° ± 1° C) for 70 hours. The test shall be conducted on at least three samples of the rubber and the average of the results reported.

4.5.4 Compatibility. Hydraulic fluid in the amount of 20, 100 and 180 ml shall be mixed with each fluid previously qualified under this specification and a total of 200 ml volumes made. These mixtures shall be prepared in 250-ml glass-stoppered flasks. The flask shall be thoroughly agitated and then stored in an oven at 550° F (288° C) for 2 hours. At the end of this time none of the mixtures shall show any signs of sediment, turbidity, or crystallization. The samples shall then be stored at -65° F (-54° C) for a period of 2 hours, at which time slight turbidity that later disappears will be permitted in the sample.

4.5.5 Specific heat. An adiabatic calorimeter shall be used to measure specific heat at 200° F (93° C). The bath temperature shall be maintained within ±0.25° F (±0.12° C) of the sample temperature. The sample temperature shall be increased at a rate of 67° F (19° C) per hour.

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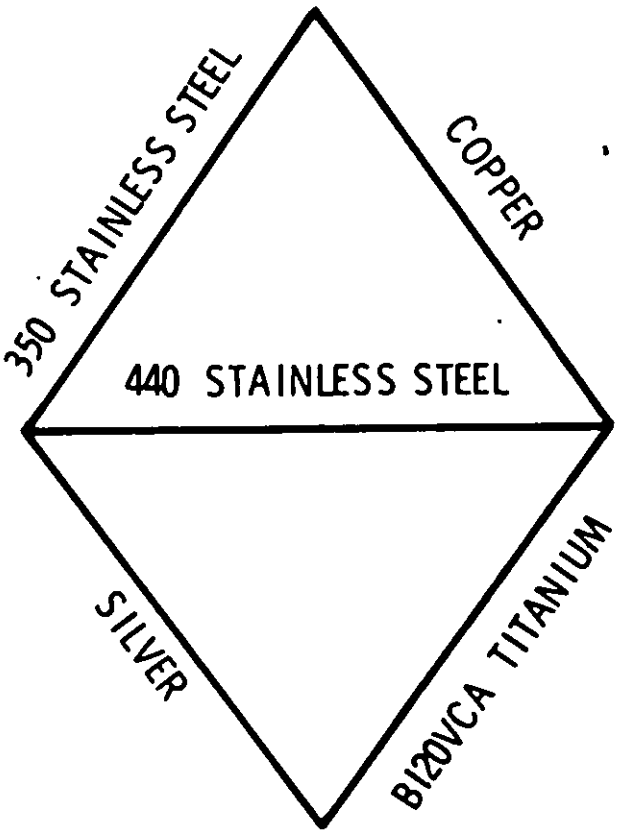


FIGURE 1. CONFIGURATION OF TEST SPECIMEN

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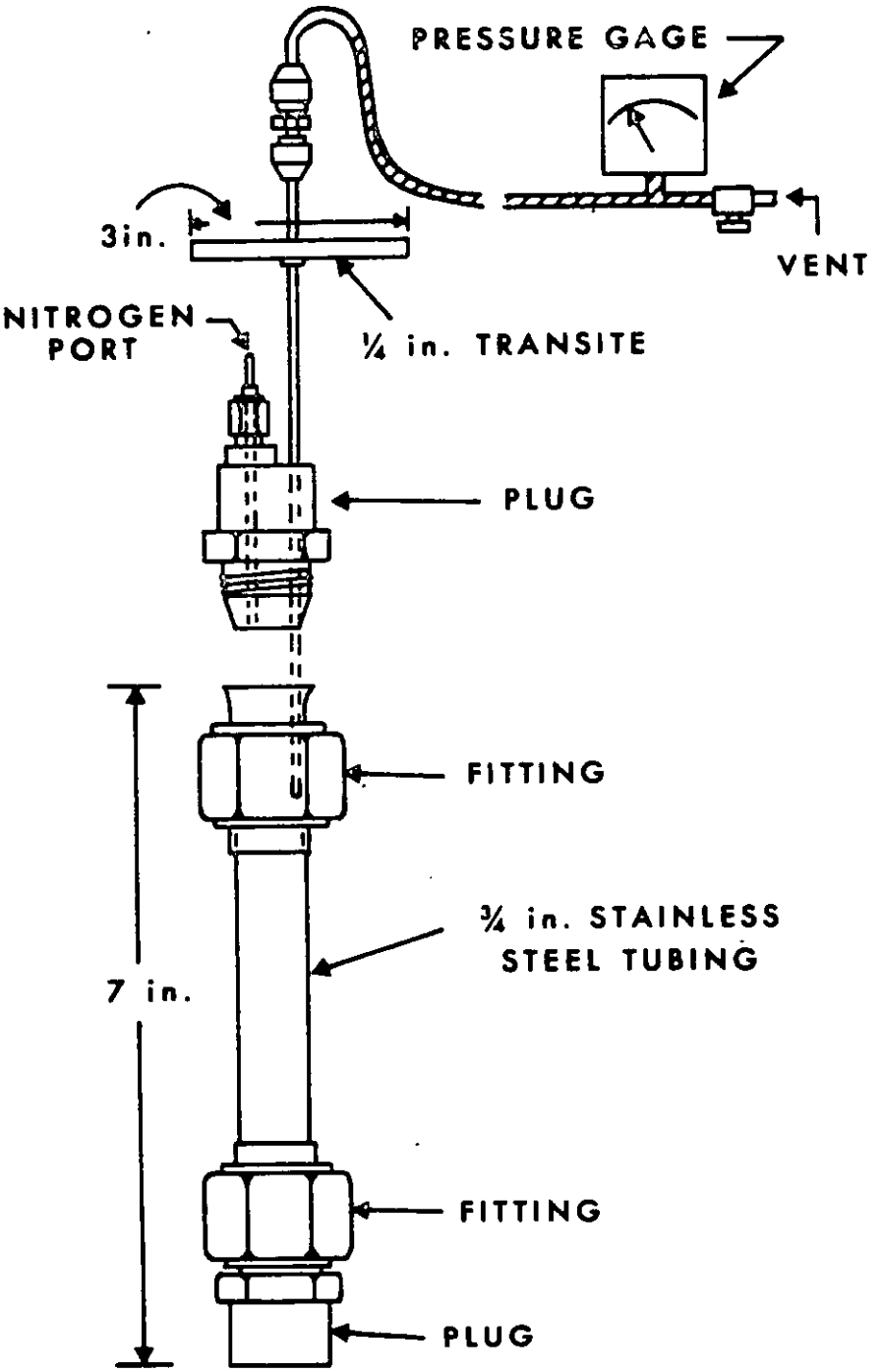


FIGURE 2. PRESSURE CYLINDER

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4.5.6 Thermal conductivity. A thin disk-type thermal conductivity tester shall be used to measure thermal conductivity at 400° F (204° C). The hydraulic fluid shall be contained between two circular blocks of copper that are situated in baths to keep the temperature gradient loss outside the copper blocks. A known quantity of heat shall be subjected to the upper block and, when a constant temperature has been maintained for a period of 2 hours, the temperature drop across the thin disk of test fluid shall be measured.

4.5.7 Bulk modulus

4.5.7.1 Apparatus. The bulk modulus of the hydraulic fluid shall be determined using a calibrated, precision capillary pycnometer of the type shown on figure 3 (modified 21T50 Jerguson pressure gage). A suitable pressure vessel and auxiliary equipment for this determination are shown on figures 4 and 5.

4.5.7.2 Procedure. The pycnometer volume to capillary diameter ratio shall be chosen to provide a precision of measurement for liquid density of ±2 parts in 10,000. The pycnometer shall be charged with candidate fluid to the top of the capillary at 100° F (37.8° C) and atmospheric pressure, and determination made as follows: Insert the pycnometer in the high-pressure pycnometer housing so that the capillary tube is visible through the window of the pressure vessel and parallel to the outside vertical surfaces of the pressure vessel. Assemble the pressure vessel containing the pycnometer, place it in a 100° F (37.8° C) constant-temperature bath, allow equilibrium to be reached, and take volume reading at atmospheric pressure. (Since the precision of the unit depends on visual readings, care must be taken to avoid errors due to parallax and distortion in the pressure vessel window and the walls of the constant-temperature bath.) Increase the nitrogen pressure to the desired pressure level and, after a 1-hour soak to achieve thermal equilibrium, take a second reading. Increase nitrogen pressure to a new level, and after a 1-hour soak, take a third reading. For any pressure range, the secant bulk modulus is defined by the following equation:

$$\text{Bulk modulus} = \frac{V\,\Delta P}{\Delta V + \Delta V_g}$$

where V is the original volume of the fluid,
ΔV is the observed volume change due to ΔP increase in pressure,
ΔP is the pressure change between the two measurements in psig, and
ΔV_g is the correction factor.

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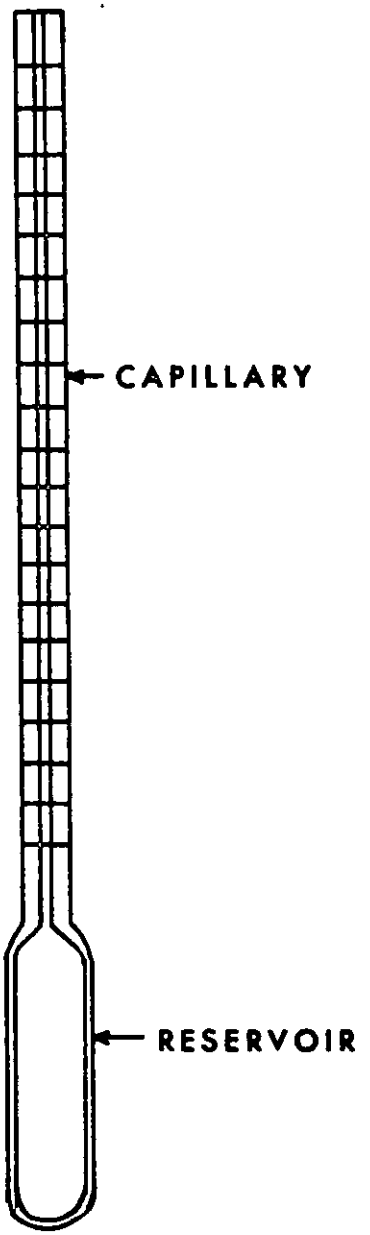


FIGURE 3. PRECISION CAPILLARY PYCNOMETER

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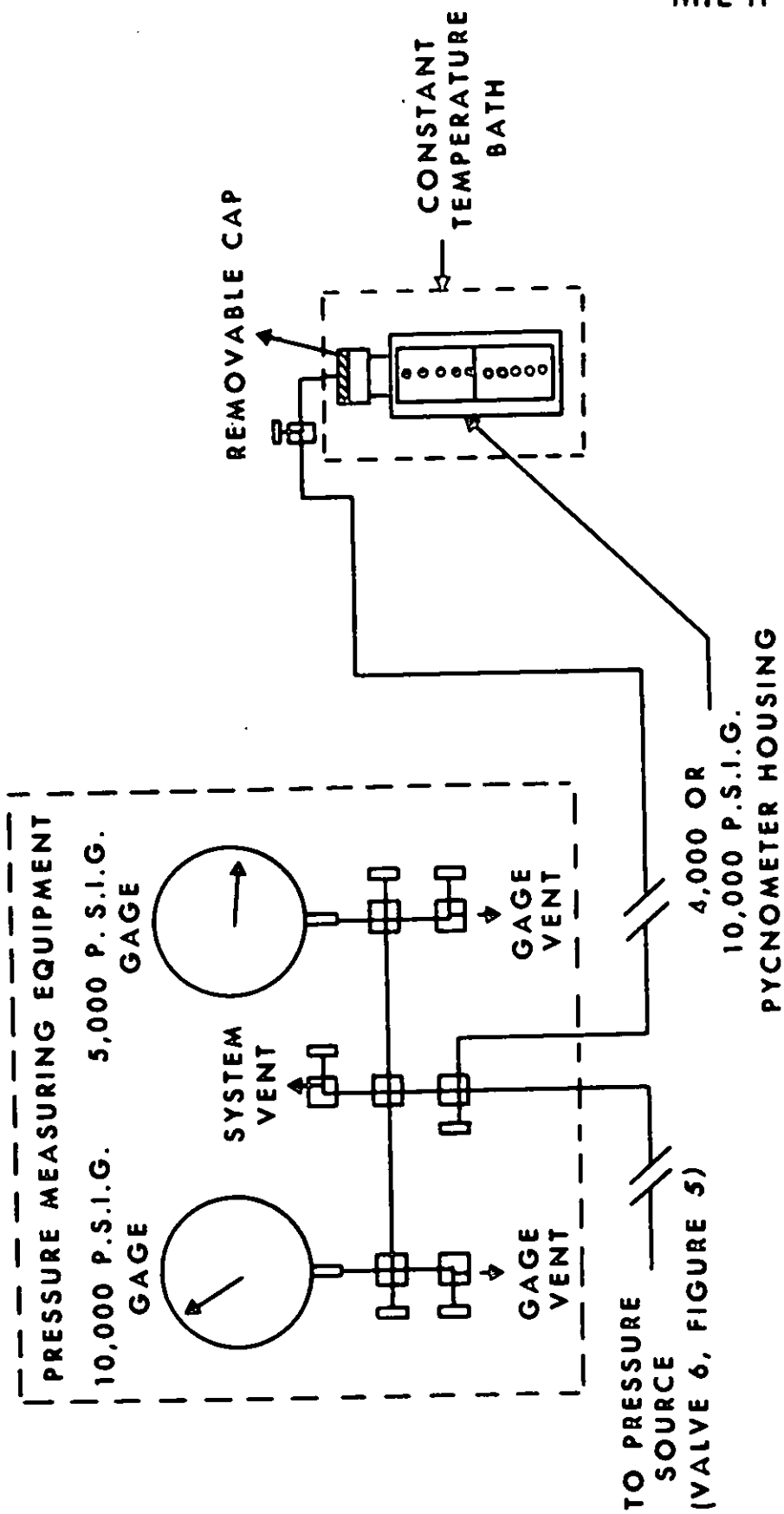


FIGURE 4. DIAGRAM OF BULK MODULUS EQUIPMENT

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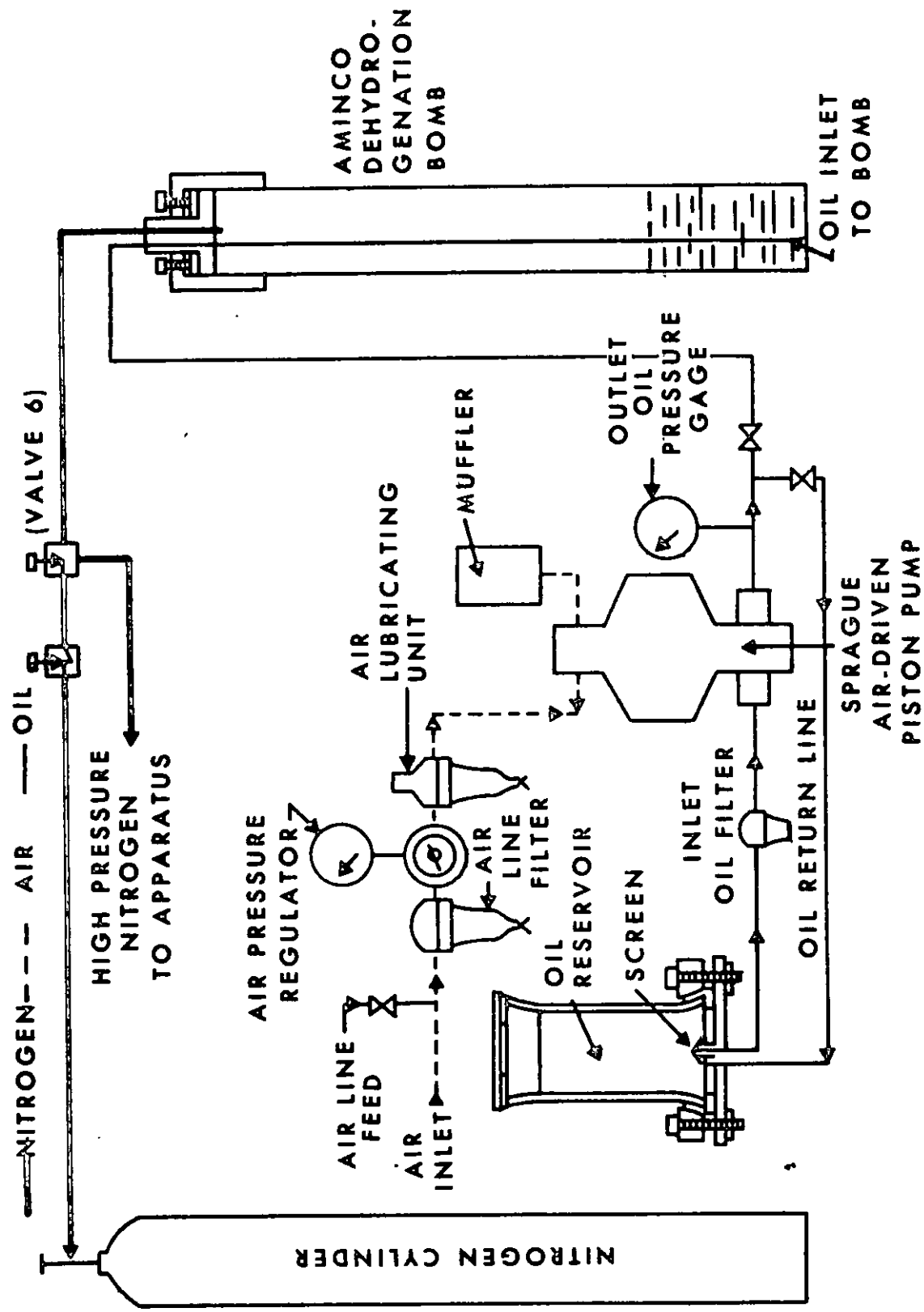


FIGURE 5. AUXILIARY EQUIPMENT

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The correction factor (ΔV_g) considers the bulk modulus of glass in determining the true volume of the pycnometers at pressures above atmospheric. The bulk modulus of Pyrex glass is 4.77×10^6 psig.

Therefore $\Delta V_g = \frac{V \Delta P}{4.77 \times 10^6}$.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing and marking. Packaging, packing and marking of the hydraulic fluid shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-290, except that the tops and bottoms of the hermetically sealed containers shall be unpainted, and container exterior walls shall be white with blue markings. The type and size of the container shall be as specified by the procuring activity (see 6.2). The container material and the hydraulic fluid shall not have any adverse effect on each other. Prior to filling, containers shall be purged of dirt, corrosion products, water, or other contaminant that would degrade the quality of the hydraulic fluid or affect oil cleanliness level as specified in 3.3.6. The fluid shall be packaged under nitrogen conforming to BB-N-411, type I, class 1, grade A. Ullage space of the container shall be inerted with a positive head of dry nitrogen not to exceed 1 psi at 70° to 100° F. The fluid as finally nitrogen sealed in the container shall have a maximum dissolved oxygen content of 15 mm partial pressure as measured by oxygen analysis equipment (see 6.4). The containers shall not contain cadmium.

5.1.1 When specified by the procuring activity, hydraulic fluid shall be packaged in 55-gallon, N.R.S.D., 18 U. S. gauge drums conforming to I.C.C. 17E. One 3/4-inch and one 2-inch closure with either rolled or shot blasted threads and black neoprene gaskets shall be used. (Tri-Sure is an acceptable closure.) Drums shall be lined with Synthetasine 200 except for the steel threads and plug. Exterior surfaces of the drum shall be painted white with blue markings.

5.1.2 Additional marking. In addition to any special marking required in the contract or order, the unit container shall be marked as follows:

INSTRUCTIONS: DESTROY ALL MARKINGS ON THIS CONTAINER WHEN EMPTY. DO NOT MIX WITH ANY FLUIDS EXCEPT THOSE OF MIL-H-27601 AND REVISIONS.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The hydraulic fluid covered by this specification is intended for use in hydraulic systems of flight vehicles over the temperature range of -40° F to +550° F (-40° to 285° C).

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Type and size of container (see 5.1, 5.1.1 and 6.2.1).

c. Quantity.

d. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1).

6.2.1 Unit of purchase. The material should be purchased by volume, the unit being a U. S. gallon at 60° F (15.6° C). For Air Force use, the hydraulic fluid will not normally be purchased in other than 1-quart or 1-gallon containers. In special cases the fluid may be procured in 55-gallon drums. (See 5.1.1.)

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for such products as have, prior to the time set for opening of bids, been tested and approved for inclusion in the applicable Qualified Products List whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the suppliers is called to this requirement, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification, in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. The activity responsible for the qualified products list is the Air Force Materials Laboratory, Attn: MAAE, Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio 45433, and information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from that activity.

6.4 Oxygen analysis equipment. Reference 5.1, suitable instruments are Beckman Instrument Company Model 777 Oxygen Analyzer and Beckman 39065 Sensor.

Custodian:
Air Force - 11

Preparing activity:
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Review activities:
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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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